RealWorld QA Assessment Report

Associate Software Developer — Oytra | Soumyadeep Roy | 8 November 2026

APPLICATION	BUILD	COVERAGE	RESULT
RealWorld / Conduit	**demo.realworld.show**	**Auth ✦ Article CRUD**	**7 issues logged**

Test summary

Objective. Exercise registration, login, article creation, editing, deletion, and logout; identify functional, usability, and accessibility defects.

Environment. RealWorld Angular demo at https://demo.realworld.show/ in the Codex in-app Chromium browser; desktop viewport; test session executed 8 November 2026 (IST).

Test data. Disposable user soumyadeep_oytra_20 261 108 and temporary article “Soumyadeep Oytra QA Automation Test”. The article was created, edited, and deleted successfully.

Functional coverage

Scenario	Outcome	Evidence
Register and authenticate	PASS	Account created; logout and login-again verified
Create article	PASS	Title, description, body, and tag persisted
Edit article	PASS	Updated description and body displayed
Delete article	PASS	Returned to global feed; article route removed from session

Defect log

ID	Title	Severity	Area	Steps to reproduce	Expected	Actual
RW-001	Weak passwords accepted	**High**	Registration	Open Sign up; enter a unique username and valid email; enter a one-character password; submit.	Reject weak passwords and state the minimum policy before submission.	The form enables submission and accepts a one-character password.
RW-002	Inputs lack persistent labels and field metadata	**Medium**	Register / Login	Inspect Sign up and Sign in fields; type values so placeholders disappear; inspect required/autocomplete/minlength attributes.	Each field has a visible label and appropriate required, autocomplete, and length metadata.	Fields rely on placeholders; useful constraint and autocomplete metadata is absent.
RW-003	Avatar links have no accessible name	**High**	Global Feed	Open Global Feed; navigate article metadata links with a screen reader or accessibility tree.	Every profile link exposes an author name or descriptive image alternative.	Avatar profile links are announced as empty links.
RW-004	Favorite controls expose icon glyphs	**High**	Global Feed	Open Global Feed; inspect or focus an article favorite button.	Control name describes the action and state, e.g. “Favorite article, 1 favorite”.	Accessible names contain private-use glyphs such as “ 1”.
RW-005	Article cards misuse level-one headings	**Medium**	Global Feed	Open Global Feed; inspect the heading outline.	One page-level h1 is followed by a logical h2/h3 hierarchy for article cards.	The page title and every article title are h1 elements, producing multiple competing top-level headings.
RW-006	Invalid login error is generic and unassociated	**Medium**	Login	Enter a valid-looking email and incorrect one-character password; submit.	Show actionable, field-associated feedback without exposing account existence.	A generic “credentials invalid” message appears without identifying the field or remediation.
RW-007	Settings route temporarily renders stale feed	**Low**	Navigation	While authenticated, select Settings and observe content before the route completes.	Show a loading state or retain the previous route until settings is ready.	The URL changes to /settings while the global feed remains visible briefly, creating a misleading active Settings state.

Root-cause analysis

The issues cluster around two systemic gaps: form-contract enforcement and accessibility-first component design. Registration appears to treat the backend's acceptance criteria as the primary validation layer, so the client does not communicate or enforce a meaningful password policy. The same form components rely on placeholder text instead of durable labels and omit browser metadata, which suggests that semantic behavior was not part of their definition of done. Feed components also render visual icons and images without deriving stable accessible names, causing empty links and private-use glyphs to leak into the accessibility tree. Repeated h1 elements indicate that card-level presentation was implemented independently of the page's document outline. The brief stale state on Settings is consistent with asynchronous route data loading without an explicit loading boundary. A shared validation schema, reusable labelled-field component, accessible icon-button primitive, automated axe checks, and route-level loading state would address the underlying causes rather than patching each symptom.

Risk and recommendations

- Prioritize RW-001, RW-003, and RW-004 because they affect account security expectations and keyboard/screen-reader access to core actions.
- Define password rules once and enforce them consistently in UI and API, while keeping authentication errors account-enumeration safe.
- Add automated accessibility checks (axe-core) to registration, login, feed, editor, article, and settings routes.
- Add component-level tests for accessible names, labels, heading hierarchy, and loading states; include keyboard-only smoke coverage in CI.

Exit statement

All required authenticated flows completed successfully. The seven issues above are reproducible in the tested build; no destructive data remains because the temporary article was deleted after verification.